Finally in November 1985, a meeting was organised at the Hague in the Netherlands where Shirazi, Hakim, Hayyan and Vipul hosted Rafsanjani's man, Farhad. The meeting did not go well. Farhad asked to see the R&AW chief, G.C. Saxena. Vipul immediately sent a coded message to his boss, Anil Prasad.

'R&AW had always worked in the shadows and the demand from Rafsanjani was a bit unusual,' said Prasad. 'Nevertheless, Garry (G.C. Saxena) was informed and we advised him to meet Farhad at least once to satisfy whatever doubts Rafsanjani had in his mind. Garry went to meet Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi, perhaps to brief him about the operation. A few days later, he asked me to arrange a meeting in Frankfurt.'

Prasad reached out to Vipul with little difficulty since he was staying in Najaf, a city in the south-central part of Iraq, with Hakim masquerading as Jamail, a Shia businessman from Kuwait. The Frankfurt meeting was held sometime in mid-December 1985, organised with the help of Hakim and Shirazi. The R&AW chief told Farhad that the Indian government was deeply committed to a bilateral relationship and whatever misconception had been spread about the India-Iran relationship was far from the truth. He also told Farhad that Vipul carried the word of the government of India and they should not suspect his authority. Farhad did not commit anything. But he assured them he would pass the message to Rafsanjani.

Farhad contacted Hakim sometime in January 1986 with a short message. His senior, Reza Bahram, would like to meet the R&AW spy Vipul. This time, a meeting was arranged in Madrid. Reza Bahram, a close aide of Rafsanjani, discussed the contours